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Hayagriva Madhava Temple

Hayagriva Madhava Temple is situated on the Manikut hill.[1] The hill is situated in Hajo of Kamrup District in Assam, India. Which is around 30 km to west of Guwahati.[1] The Kalika Purana composed in the 11th century CE in Kamarupa talks about the origin of this form of Vishnu and his final establishment in the hill of Monikut, where the present temple is located. [2] The present temple structure was constructed by the King Raghudeva Narayan in 1583.[3] According to some historians the King of Pala dynasty constructed it in 10th century. It is a stone temple and it enshrines an image of Hayagriva Madhava. Some Buddhists believe that the Hayagriva Madhava temple, best known in the group of Hindu temples, is where the Buddha attained Nirvana. At this imposing temple, the presiding deity is Vishnu, worshipped in the sanctum sanctorum as an idol carved of black stone. Four other stone idols are also in worship as subsidiary deities.

A most striking feature of the temple is the continuous row of elephants carved on the lowest level of the temple walls - a structure akin to the stone cut temple of Ellora. The outer walls of the shrine is also covered with relief figures of the ten incarnations of Vishnu, devotees in procession and episodic scenes from the Ramayana and the Mahabharata. There is a big pond known as Madhab Pukhuri near the temple. Doul, Bihu and Janmastami festivals are celebrated every year in the temple.

Sayani, the first wife of Kalia Bhomora Borphukan donated a family of paiks and also a plot of land for their maintenance to the Hayagriva Madhava temple during the reign of Ahom king Kamaleswar Singha. The lamps in the sanctum sanctorum are never put off (akhanda deep) ever. Oil flows into the big earthen lamps through a simple tube connected to the oil tin.

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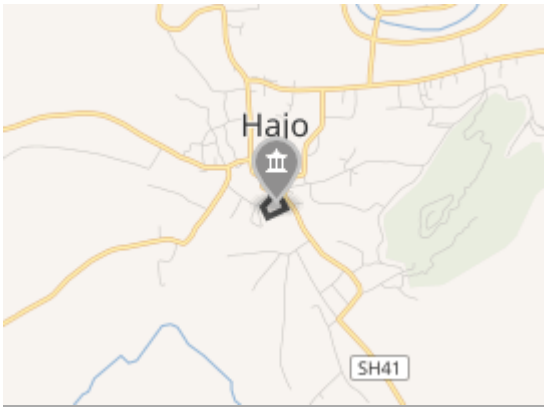
Religion	
Affiliation	Hinduism
District	Kamrup
Deity	Vishnu as Hayagriva
Festivals	Doul Utsav, Janmastami

Location	
Location	Hajo
State	Assam
Country	India



Interactive map of Hayagriva Madhava Temple

Architecture

Creator	Urbarishi Reconstructed by: Raghudeva Narayan
Completed	1583

Inscription of the temple, issued by Raghudeva Narayan

References

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2. Lavoni, Sama (2014). "SHAYAGRIVA MADHAVA TEMPLE AND SACRED GEOGRAPHY OF HAJO". *Proceedings of the Indian History Congress*. **75**: 364–370. ISSN 2249-1937 (https://search.worldcat.org/issn/2249-1937). JSTOR 44158404 (https://www.jstor.org/stable/44158404).
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